Lead Broker Blueprint

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Module 6

Operations and Tooling

What this module does

Module 6 covers the operational stack of a real lead generation business: the minimum viable tech stack, the lead distribution platforms that sit at the center of the operation, call tracking, consent capture, team structure as the business scales, and the operational pitfalls that take down newer operators.

By the end of the module you can: describe the minimum tech stack required to run a compliant operation; choose between LeadConduit, Boberdoo, Phonexa, and Leadspedia; budget for the operational stack at $200/month and $5,000/month tiers; and recognize the operational mistakes that show up in the post-mortems of failed lead-gen operations.

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Module 6 overview

Six lessons:

- 6.1 The minimum viable tech stack.
- 6.2 Lead distribution platforms.
- 6.3 Call tracking.
- 6.4 Consent capture and verification.
- 6.5 Team structure as you scale.
- 6.6 Common operational pitfalls.

Two deliverables: a tech stack comparison spreadsheet (organized by price tier and vertical fit), and sample SOPs for intake and lead delivery.

Lesson 6.1 — The minimum viable tech stack

> **Learning objective**
> Name the seven categories of tooling a compliant lead-gen operation needs from day one. Budget honestly across two tiers ($200/month and $5,000/month).

The seven categories

1. Landing page builder (Unbounce, Instapage, Leadpages, Webflow, Carrd at the low end).
2. Form / intake tool (built into the landing-page builder or via Typeform, Tally, JotForm).
3. CRM (HubSpot, Salesforce, Pipedrive, or a vertical-specific tool).
4. Consent capture / verification (TrustedForm or Jornaya — both have free trial tiers but real usage is paid).
5. Lead distribution platform (LeadConduit, Boberdoo, Phonexa, Leadspedia — covered in Lesson 6.2).
6. Call tracking (CallRail, Invoca, Retreaver, Ringba — covered in Lesson 6.3).
7. Payment / billing (Stripe, QuickBooks, FreshBooks).

Two tiers

Starter tier ($200-500/month)

- Landing page: Carrd ($19/yr) or Leadpages ($49/mo).
- Forms: built into the LP tool, or Tally (free) for multi-step.
- CRM: HubSpot free tier or Pipedrive ($15/seat/mo).
- Consent: TrustedForm at usage-based pricing (small operators commonly land $50-200/mo at low volume).
- Lead distribution: at this tier, simple email/HTTP POST routing handled manually or via Zapier/Make ($20-50/mo).
- Call tracking: CallRail Lite ($45/mo).
- Payment: Stripe (transaction-based) or QuickBooks Online ($30/mo).

Total at the very low end: roughly $200-500/month for tooling, before ad spend.

Mid tier ($1,000-5,000/month)

- Landing page: Unbounce or Instapage ($100-300/mo).
- CRM: HubSpot Sales Hub ($45-90/seat/mo) or Salesforce Essentials ($35/seat/mo).
- Consent: TrustedForm with full feature set ($300-1,500/mo at moderate volume).

- Lead distribution: LeadConduit ($500-3,000/mo depending on volume) or Boberdoo (similar tier).
- Call tracking: CallRail Pro ($165/mo) or Ringba (usage-based).
- Reporting / BI: Looker Studio (free) or Mixpanel/Amplitude ($25-250/mo).

Total at this tier: $1,000-5,000/month for tooling, before ad spend and labor.

What's not on the list (and why)

- Generic email marketing tools (Mailchimp, Klaviyo) — appropriate for nurture but not for lead capture / consent. Don't substitute for proper consent capture.
- Marketing automation suites (Marketo, Pardot) — overkill for most lead-gen operations; useful when you're closer to B2B SaaS scale.
- AI content tools — useful for drafting, dangerous for landing-page testimonial content (FTC Reviews Rule, Module 3.7).

On-camera summary

Seven categories. Tier 1 runs ~$200-500/month at very small scale; Tier 2 runs $1,000-5,000/month at meaningful scale. The categories that should not be skipped: consent capture and call tracking; weak setup on these creates real compliance exposure.

Sources

- Public pricing pages of each named vendor (verify before purchase; tiers and prices change).
- LeadsCouncil and Performance Marketing Association tooling surveys.

Lesson 6.2 — Lead distribution platforms

> **Learning objective**
> Compare the four major lead distribution platforms (LeadConduit, Boberdoo, Phonexa, Leadspedia), recognize when you need one, and choose the right one for your stage and vertical.

Why you'll eventually need one

Below ~50 leads/month and ~2 buyers, you can route leads manually with email and a spreadsheet (or simple Zapier/Make automations). Above that, the operational burden of manual routing — deduplication, qualification filtering, scoring, sending to the right buyer, return handling, consent-record retention, revocation propagation — exceeds what an operator can sustain. A distribution platform automates the routing and consolidates the audit trail.

The four platforms compared

Platform	Strength	Typical use case	Approximate pricing
LeadConduit (ActiveProspect)	Dominant; deep TrustedForm integration; broad partner ecosystem.	Aggregators and large generators across insurance, legal, home services.	$500-3,000+/mo depending on volume; usage-based.
Boberdoo	Operator flexibility; ping-post auction features; lower-tier pricing.	Mid-size networks running their own buyer panels.	$200-1,500/mo + per-lead fees; varies.
Phonexa	End-to-end performance marketing; strong on call routing and CRM integration.	Blended form-and-call operations; pay-per-call-heavy.	$500-3,000+/mo; usage-based.
Leadspedia	Affiliate-network flavor; publisher management; affiliate-style attribution.	Affiliate networks; financial services and insurance affiliate setups.	$300-2,000/mo + per-lead; varies.

How to choose

8. If you're an aggregator or generator working in legal / home services / insurance with TrustedForm in your stack — LeadConduit is the default and the path-of-least-resistance choice.

9. If you're a smaller operator who wants more pricing flexibility and is comfortable configuring more yourself — Boberdoo.
10. If your inventory is meaningfully call-based (pay-per-call or live transfer) — Phonexa.
11. If your traffic is affiliate-sourced and you need publisher-side management — Leadspedia.

None of these decisions is permanent; operators frequently switch platforms as scale and inventory mix change. The platforms are infrastructure, not strategy.

On-camera summary

LeadConduit is the dominant platform; the others have specific strengths. Don't add a platform before you need it; do add one before the manual operational burden of routing exceeds your bandwidth. Switching is normal.

Sources

- Public product documentation: activeprospect.com, boberdoo.com, phonexa.com, leadspedia.com.
- LeadsCon platform-comparison sessions (annual).

Lesson 6.3 — Call tracking

> **Learning objective**
> Articulate what call tracking actually does, recognize the state-by-state consent-to-record landscape, and choose call tracking that fits form-lead vs. pay-per-call operations.

Three jobs call tracking does

12. Dynamic number insertion. Each visitor sees a unique phone number, so calls can be attributed to the specific traffic source (ad campaign, landing page, keyword). Foundation for any paid-acquisition attribution.
13. Call recording and quality scoring. Recordings support intake training, qualification verification, and dispute resolution. Modern platforms (Invoca especially) auto-score recordings using AI.
14. Call routing and IVR. Pay-per-call operations route calls through qualification IVR ("Press 1 if homeowner, press 2 if renter") and to live agents based on call attributes.

State-by-state consent-to-record

What regulations require: U.S. states fall into two categories for call recording. "One-party consent" states allow recording with consent of only one party (the seller's agent). "Two-party (all-party) consent" states require consent from every party on the call. As of 2026, the all-party states include California, Connecticut, Delaware, Florida, Illinois, Maryland, Massachusetts, Michigan (in some interpretations), Montana, Nevada (effective 2024), New Hampshire, Oregon, Pennsylvania, and Washington. Recording calls without disclosure in these states is a state law violation and may carry criminal exposure.

Operational implication: every recorded call should open with a disclosure ("This call is being recorded for quality assurance"). Recordings should be retained at minimum five years for TSR purposes.

Vendor choice

- CallRail — the workhorse for form-lead operators who use call tracking primarily for attribution. Easy to configure; integrates with major CRMs and ad platforms.
- Invoca — enterprise-grade conversation analytics. Strong with large buyers; overkill for small operators.
- Retreaver — pay-per-call-focused; competitive with Phonexa and Ringba for call routing.
- Ringba — pay-per-call routing; popular with smaller pay-per-call operations.

On-camera summary

Call tracking does three things: dynamic number insertion for attribution, recording and scoring, and IVR/routing. State-by-state consent-to-record rules matter; disclose every recorded call. CallRail for form-lead operators; Ringba / Retreaver / Phonexa for pay-per-call.

Sources

- State call-recording statutes (see Reporter's Committee for Freedom of the Press summary).
- CallRail, Invoca, Retreaver, Ringba public product documentation.
- TSR five-year retention rule, 16 C.F.R. § 310.5.

Lesson 6.4 — Consent capture and verification

> **Learning objective**
> Articulate what TrustedForm and Jornaya actually do, when they're contractually required, and how they fit into the lead-distribution workflow.

What they do, technically

Both TrustedForm (ActiveProspect) and Jornaya (Verisk) produce a tamper-evident certificate URL that records the consumer's session at the moment of form submission. The certificate captures:

- The page URL on which consent was obtained.
- The exact disclosure text the consumer saw.
- Mouse, keystroke, and timestamp metadata.
- The named parties whose calls and texts the consumer authorized.
- A unique certificate ID retained by the vendor.

The certificate URL is delivered with the lead. Sophisticated buyers retain it as evidence of compliant consent capture; in litigation, the certificate is the seller's primary defense against PEWC-defect claims.

Why buyers require them

The plaintiff's bar in TCPA cases can identify defective consent records in discovery. A buyer that can produce a TrustedForm or Jornaya certificate for every delivered lead has a meaningful defense; a buyer that cannot has substantial exposure. As of May 2026 most sophisticated insurance and legal buyers require certified consent records contractually. New vendors that cannot deliver them are filtered out at procurement.

Operational integration

Both products are JavaScript snippets installed on the landing page. The snippet records the consumer's session and produces the certificate URL at submission. The URL is then included in the form post or API call that delivers the lead to LeadConduit (or equivalent) and onward to the buyer.

Retention requirements: certificate URLs should be retained at minimum five years (TSR record-keeping plus general litigation-defense posture).

On-camera summary

TrustedForm and Jornaya are evidence vendors. They produce certificate URLs proving the disclosure language and consent action a consumer saw. Sophisticated buyers require them; the operational cost is small relative to the litigation-defense value.

Sources

- ActiveProspect / TrustedForm public product documentation.
- Jornaya / Verisk Marketing Solutions public product documentation.
- 47 C.F.R. § 64.1200(f)(9) (PEWC standard).

Lesson 6.5 — Team structure as you scale

> **Learning objective**
> Sequence the first 5-10 hires in a lead-gen operation. Match each hire to the operational pain it solves.

Sequencing in roughly the order operators describe

Stage 0 — Solo founder

The founder does everything: media buying, landing page design, intake calls (if any), buyer relationships, payments. Ceiling: typically $20-40k/month gross revenue depending on vertical. Above this, the constraints are hours-in-the-day, not market opportunity.

Stage 1 — First VA / intake hire ($30-60k or part-time)

First hire is usually a virtual assistant or part-time intake agent. Solves: phone-based intake on inbound calls or outbound qualification of form submissions. The founder reclaims time for higher-leverage work (media buying, buyer relationships, compliance).

Stage 2 — Media buyer ($70-130k)

Second hire is often a specialist media buyer (paid search and/or paid social) to professionalize the supply side. Solves: the founder is no longer the bottleneck on campaign optimization. ROI is faster scaling of existing supply channels.

Stage 3 — Operations / account manager ($60-100k)

Third hire handles buyer relationships, contract administration, dispute handling, and quality monitoring. Solves: buyers want a consistent point of contact, and the founder can't be that person while also running the business.

Stage 4 — Compliance officer or fractional counsel ($50-150k or counsel retainer)

Around the time you're handling more than 10,000 leads/month or operating across multiple state regimes, a dedicated compliance function (full-time or fractional) becomes essential. Solves: keeping up with regulatory changes (quarterly reviews) and conducting internal audits.

Stage 5 — Ops manager and second media buyer

Beyond Stage 4, the team typically expands with operational management (running the day-to-day, freeing the founder for strategy) and additional supply-side hires.

On-camera summary

The first 5 hires solve specific operational pains in sequence: intake, media buying, account management, compliance, then operational depth. Hiring out of sequence wastes money; hiring on schedule generally pays for itself within 90 days per hire.

Sources

- Operator commentary across LeadsCon and the long-running lead-gen podcasts.
- Public salary benchmark data (Glassdoor, Salary.com, LinkedIn Salary Insights).

Lesson 6.6 — Common operational pitfalls

> **Learning objective**
> Recognize the operational mistakes that show up in the post-mortems of failed lead-gen operations. Build a watch-list of warning signs.

Six pitfalls operators repeatedly cite

1. Overpaying for traffic before product-market fit on the buyer side

The newcomer mistake: spend $10k on paid search to produce a batch of leads, then discover there's no buyer willing to take them at the price needed. Generation without demand is a way to lose capital quickly. Module 7 covers buyer-first sequencing as the antidote.

2. Selling leads you can't reliably deliver

Promising 200 exclusive leads per week to a buyer when your traffic only produces 80, then trying to cover the gap with lower-quality inventory. Buyers notice within two weeks; the relationship ends; the operator's reputation takes a hit that's hard to recover.

3. Compliance shortcuts that catch up six months later

Common shortcuts: skipping TrustedForm to save $200/month at small volume; co-registration consent flows that named multiple sellers vaguely; reusing landing pages across verticals without re-checking disclosure language; running paid social creative that uses fabricated testimonials. Each of these produces no immediate consequence; six months in, a class action attorney finds the defective disclosure or a regulator opens an inquiry.

4. Vendor concentration risk on the demand side

Running 60-80% of revenue through one large buyer. The buyer changes their procurement strategy, has a quality issue, or shifts to internal generation; revenue collapses. Operators repeatedly cite this as the failure mode that took down many otherwise-functional operations between 2022 and 2025 (when insurance carriers compressed marketing spend).

5. Tooling under-investment

Saving money on the operational stack by running on email-and-spreadsheet routing past the volume where it's sustainable. Result: missed leads, double-sold leads, slow dispute handling, eroded buyer trust.

6. Founder time on the wrong work

The founder optimizes Google Ads at midnight when they should be on a call with a prospective buyer the next morning. Or the founder spends three days configuring LeadConduit when they could have

hired a contractor to do it in a week. The leverage of founder time is on relationships and strategy; tactical optimization is hire-able.

On-camera summary

Six operational pitfalls: overpaying for traffic without buyers, over-promising volume, compliance shortcuts, vendor concentration, tooling under-investment, and founder time on the wrong work. Build a quarterly self-review against this list.

Sources

- Operator post-mortems published on LeadsCon, in the LeadsCouncil community, and on long-running lead-gen podcasts.
- Module 7 — Starting from Zero — picks up the validation-first methodology that prevents pitfall #1 specifically.

Module 6 wrap-up and what's next

You've now covered the operational stack, the platform-layer choices, call tracking, consent capture, team structure, and the operational mistakes that take down newer operators. The two deliverables operationalize the lessons.

What Module 7 covers

Module 7 is the honest readiness assessment and the 90-day-decision framework. It applies everything in Modules 1-6 to the question of whether this is the right business for you to start, and if so, how to sequence the first 90 days.